Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida REID

Name	Sarah-Jane Elizabeth CLULOW
Occupation	Unemployed
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	11/10/2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Sarah-Jane Elizabeth CLULOW. I am 35 years of age.
3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Agency (NDIA).

4. I have medically diagnosed with a neuromuscular condition. Due to the disability, I have received benefits from the Australian Government through NDIS since 2018. My NDIS Participant number is 430838840.
5. I know Vida Reid (VIDA). I was put in touch with her from a previous support provider, Fay Abdi.
6. I am aware she and her husband Simon Reid are the founders, owners, creators and directors of an unregistered provider business called Forward Focus Group (FFG). VIDA has provided support services in the form of support coordination and psychology to me from the end of October 2021 to the end of 22 July 2022. I know this because I sent an email to Vida on 24 June 2022 giving one months' notice to cancel services.
7. I remember Vida told me she was the one in the business who put in the invoices.
8. I remember VIDA made a service agreement for support coordination and a psychologist Sally SEE.

9. I am also aware they have another provider businesses called Hybrid Hive (HH). I have received services through HH as well from 24 January 2022 to 22 June 2022.
10. I have never signed any service agreement for HH but am aware they provided services.
11. As VIDA's companies are unregistered provider comapnies, I am aware the invoices for her services are put though a Plan Management Agency called Assist Plan Managers. The person I deal with is Anthony Harrison. I am aware the plan manager is supposed to send out the invoices for approval to me. Initially I was not getting any statements or invoices from the plan manager. I contacted the plan manager and asked to receive the invoices for my approval. I sent them an email on 2 May 2022 with this request. From then on I used an app called 'Careview' which sends me an email with attached invoices that are pending my approval. I then check the invoice for the services that were provided and approve or if there is a problem, I contact the plan manager.
12. Vida is aware I use the app now because I remember she called me and asked me why I was approving the claims and she could not continue approving the claims. She asked me why she had been taken off the approval. I told her I was increasing my independence. She told me I was not supposed to be doing it as I did not have the capacity. She asked me to have my pin number so she can have access but I didn't give it to her. This phone call was within two days of me getting approval.
13. The services provided by Vida from FFG was initially only support coordination until psychology was provided with Sally. I started seeing Sally in December 2021. This was after I was in hospital from around 10 to 15 December 2021.
14. I remember I was told I would need 24 hour care after hospital. I remember I didn't think I needed it but I did receive 24 hour care for a few days. The person who told me this was Ikram Farah who director of a support services company called Empowering Community Disability (ECD). I believe she was providing supports to Vida's son Alex.
15. I have copies of the invoices on my computer since I have been receiving them.
16. I know there are false invoices because I have seen invoices for the same dates from FFG, HH and ECD. I have also seen invoices for services that definitely were not provided. I have compiled a list of all the services that were falsely claimed by Vida.

17. On 11 October 2022, I had a conversation with NDIS Investigator Brenda Ryan. She was making enquiries into the claiming that had occurred against my plan.
18. As a result of that conversation and by looking at the invoices I have, I can say the following in relation to incorrect services I have receives from FFG and HH:

- Invoice no 1217 from FFG is for $3,127.50. The invoice was for pharmacy products. I know the pharmacy total was for only $2,470.00. I remember Vida spoke to me about this and I asked her why there was a difference. She told me she had to charge extra for tax. I believe this extra amount claimed was false.
- I can say that any claims for Short Term Accommodation (STA) from any of companies FFG, HH or ECD are false. I never received any STA from any of them. I only time I stayed anywhere was on the occasion of the Crown towers for two nights and one other occasion for one night at the Quest on the 31st December 2021. On that evening one support worker was with me.
- I can say that FFG never provided any support workers ever. So any claims made by FFG for supports like community access, house cleaning, assist with selfcare, community participation is false.
- HH did provide supports for a while from 24 or 25 January 2022 to 22 June 2022. They provided things like, personal care, access to community but no cleaning.
- Never did any of these companies provide house cleaning. Any cleaning claims from any of these companies is false. The only cleaner I have had is from Safe and Clean and Ema Rakatau.
- I can also say whenever I have carers from these companies, I have only had one carer at a time.
- I have seen invoices claimed by FFG, HH and ECD on the same dates. Because only ever one carer at a time was here, these claims are doubled charged and are incorrect.
- I am aware there are claims made under Self-Management Building Capacity. I am aware this is supposed be for being taught how to manage my goals like, budgeting. I have never received any services from any company for self-management building capacity. Any claims under this category is false. No one has ever helped me or teach me to cook, budget or any other kind of related assistance.
- Invoice Number 0983 from FFG lists psychology claims for 4 days with 4 hours each day from 14 March 2022 to 17 March 2022 and also on the 18 March 2022 for

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3.5 hours and 4hours on the following Monday the 21st March 2022. Also 3.5 hrs from 22 to 25 March 2022. There is another 4hrs on Monday 28th March and 3.5hrs from 29-31st March 2022. During this entire time, I only ever saw the physiologist for 1 hour every week. So all the extra times are false.

- There were also claims for pshycology from 1-4 April and 18-20 April 2022. Again, these claims are false because I stopped using Sally around the 5th of April 2022 and again only had almost one hour a week other than on one occasion where I saw her twice in one week.
- Invoice NDIS 1146-1 on 13 Jan 2022 for travel and 14 Jan for travel. I can say she never took me anywhere on those dates. Any claims for travel on this invoice is false.
- Invoice NDIS 1375-1 totalled 5hrs with Sally. I have never spent 5 hours with Sally. Most of the time I saw Sally at Safety Bay but she came from the Armadale office to the Safety Bay office.

19. I can also comment on improper behaviour by Vida.
    - In February 2022, Vida asked me to download a form and complete a fake Covid 19 vaccination certificate so I could go on a cruise. I did this because she told me it was ok to do this as I had a disability. On 9 February 2022 she sent me the link. The cruise was on 13 February 2022 but I stayed at the Crown towers for the event from 12 February 10 14 February 2022. I stayed there myself. I remember Vida's son's carer was there for the first night. The cruise was an event that FFG was doing. Vida told me it was for people like myself who have medical reasons for not being vaccinated yet.
    - I am aware Vida sent unvaccinated staff who cared for me during the Covid 19 mandatory time period. Their names were Donna, Kristie and Melissa.
    - I know they weren't vaccinated because they told me and also they were not allowed into certain places, like the movies.
    - She has lied to me about Alex Bowers who was my coordinator for FFG. She told me Alex tried to kill himself because of me. This made me feel scared and upset. I was crying and felt guilty because she told me if he died, I would go to jail. Since she told me this, I have not trusted providers since.

- Since I have left, Vida has threatened me to come back to her company by saying that an office manager called Jan Nuttal was sacked because she told Alex to kill himself. This is not true as I have spoken to Jan. This also made me feel guilty.
- She also threatened me by telling me Simon was an ex-navy seal and he could make me disappear and I would never be found. I believe she meant that I would not be found ever again.
- She has also threatened me by telling me she would go to Mark McGowan and have my NDIS funding removed and I would have to pay everything back.

This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature S.Clulow
Sarah-Jane Elizabeth CLULOW

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about ...12.20p.m.... on 11 October 2022 at Medina in Western Australia.

Signature
Brenda Ryan
NDIS Fraud Investigator